Deadline Eve

S&P +0.43% as ceasefire hopes offset Tuesday strike threat. ISM Services cools to 54, prices surge to 70.7. Digital assets lead; IBIT +4.08%.

THE SESSION

Markets held their nerve on the eve of the biggest binary event since the conflict began. The S&P 500 gained 0.43% to 6,611, the Dow added 0.36%, and the Nasdaq rose 0.54% as investors balanced ceasefire optimism against President Trump's threat to strike Iranian power plants and bridges by Tuesday at 8 PM ET. This was the first session for equities to digest Friday's March nonfarm payrolls report—+178,000 jobs versus a 60,000 consensus—and this morning's ISM Services PMI, which cooled to 54.0 from 56.1 while the prices subindex surged to 70.7, the highest since October 2022. The employment subindex dropped to 45.2, its lowest since December 2023. The message from the data: economic activity is resilient but input costs are accelerating, and the labor side of services is beginning to feel the strain of the conflict's secondary effects.

Trading volumes were thin with European markets closed for Easter Monday, producing a session that drifted sideways for most of the afternoon before settling near the highs. The ISM commentary was dominated by references to the Iran conflict and the expected flow-through of higher oil and fuel costs. Supplier deliveries slowed further (56.2 versus 53.9 in February), consistent with the Hormuz closure's ongoing disruption to shipping and flight routes. New orders accelerated to 60.6—the strongest reading since February 2023—suggesting that demand remains intact even as cost pressures build. The juxtaposition is the session in miniature: strength underneath, uncertainty on top.

Sector leadership told the day's story. Digital assets led the tape as ceasefire hopes lifted risk appetite: IBIT gained 4.08%, ETHA 3.65%, and Bitcoin approached $70,000. Semiconductors rallied on Citi's 30-day positive catalyst watches on AMD and ADI ahead of Q1 earnings—ADI gained 2.83%, the day's top holding performer. Defense names extended their run: LMT added 2.43% after the Pentagon's FY2027 budget requested 85 F-35s, nearly double last year's 47. Energy was mixed, with VLO gaining 0.61% while CVX was essentially flat.

IOWN Tactical: The S&P sits 8.4% below its all-time high. The first buy tranche activates at −20% from peak. Tuesday's deadline is the near-term catalyst; the NFP print and ISM prices data are the medium-term signals. The portfolio's construction—defense, energy, digital assets, dividend compounders—was designed for exactly this kind of compressed event window. Patience is the position.

IOWN HOLDINGS: NOTABLE MOVERS

WINNERS

IBIT +4.08% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Bitcoin approached $70,000 as ceasefire hopes lifted risk appetite across the digital asset space. Strategy resumed BTC purchases; Bitmine reported nearly 4% ETH supply ownership.

ETHA +3.65% — DIGITAL ASSET ETF

Ethereum rallied in sympathy with Bitcoin. Institutional on-ramps continue to multiply with Schwab's direct crypto trading plans and Morgan Stanley's MSBT ETF listing.

FINV +3.44% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Chinese fintech gained on broader EM risk-on sentiment and continued strength in consumer lending volumes.

HUT +3.06% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Bitcoin mining and infrastructure name rallied alongside the broader digital asset complex on ceasefire optimism.

ADI +2.83% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Citi placed a 30-day positive catalyst watch ahead of Q1 earnings, citing 10–15% analog price increases on higher input costs. Citi's estimates sit above Street consensus for April and July quarters.

CNX +2.53% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Natural gas producer gained as energy pricing dynamics remained constructive. The Hormuz disruption continues to support broader energy complex pricing.

LMT +2.43% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Pentagon's FY2027 budget requested 85 F-35 jets, nearly double last year's 47. Trump's $1.5 trillion defense budget prioritizes force readiness and lethality.

DECLINERS

STLD –2.04% — DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Steel producer declined despite ISM Manufacturing PMI showing expansion. Rising input costs (ISM Prices at 78.3) and construction steel noted as up in price may be pressuring margins expectations.

GFI –1.89% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Gold miner pulled back as gold was flat at $4,684, consolidating after recent volatility around the Warsh Fed Chair confirmation news.

ATAT –1.51% — GROWTH PORTFOLIO

Atmus Filtration declined on thin trading volume; no company-specific catalyst identified.

FAST –0.93% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Industrial distributor gave back ground despite solid ISM new orders. May reflect profit-taking after recent strength.

QCOM –0.84% DIVIDEND STRATEGY

Qualcomm drifted lower as Citi's semiconductor outlook flagged caution on smartphone chipmakers, expecting rising memory costs to weigh on low-end unit demand.

HOLDINGS NEWS

COIN: Coinbase OCC trust charter enters second week of market digestion. Coinbase received conditional approval from the Office of the Comptroller of the Currency last Thursday to establish Coinbase National Trust Company—a federally regulated digital asset custodian. The charter would give Coinbase qualified national status to custody assets and operate payment products under federal supervision. It does not authorize commercial banking or deposit-taking. The ICBA issued a statement opposing the approval. COIN gained 1.94% today to $174.79.

ADI and AMD: Citi catalyst watches ahead of Q1 earnings. Citi placed 30-day positive catalyst watches on both names. For AMD, the thesis centers on rising CPU demand from agentic AI workloads and expected hyperscaler capex growth of 69% this year. For ADI, the catalyst is 10–15% analog price increases confirmed through supply chain conversations. Citi's total addressable market estimate for data center semiconductors reaches $731 billion by 2028. ADI rose 2.83%; AMD gained 1.23%.

LMT: Pentagon FY2027 budget requests 85 F-35s. The proposed budget requests 85 Lockheed Martin F-35 fighter jets—38 F-35A for the Air Force, 10 F-35B for the Marine Corps, and 37 F-35C carrier variants. This nearly doubles the 47 jets requested last year and is part of Trump's $1.5 trillion defense budget. LMT rose 2.43% to $637.90. Q1 earnings are April 23.

PORTFOLIO PERFORMANCE

DIVIDEND STRATEGY ✓ BEAT ONE

+0.25%

vs. DVY +0.18% | IWS +0.41%

GROWTH PORTFOLIO ✓ BEAT

+0.66%

vs. IUSG +0.41%

YEAR-TO-DATE

Dividend +6.10% vs DVY +7.65% / IWS +3.98%
Growth –1.03% vs IUSG +6.67%